Optima Academy Online
An Education Experience Company

PHILOSOPHY HONORS: ETHICS

Suggested 18 Week Sequence
Semester 1 · Weeks 1–18

Teacher's Module	Covers	Student Copy
Suggested 18 Week Sequence	Weeks 1–18 (Quarters 1–2) · every week, lesson, and graded item	Course Guide & Schedule

This is the teacher's planning copy of the first semester, week by week: what students read and study, and what's due. It carries the same content as the student-facing Course Guide & Schedule, in the same format, so nothing drifts between what a teacher plans against and what a student actually sees. A matching sequence for the second semester (Weeks 19–36) will be posted separately.

How each week works. Every week centers on one lesson, paired with a Comprehension Check quiz on that week's material (5 pts, auto-graded) and one graded Assignment, Discussion, or Warm-Up applying that week's ideas. Full essay-depth Assignments and Discussions are worth 100 pts; the shorter Warm-Ups that replaced some Discussions this semester are worth 20 pts. Each module opens with a short reflection survey and closes with one that revisits it; neither counts toward your grade. The last week of most modules also carries a Module Capstone (100 pts), a deeper assessment drawing on the whole module. See the Course Syllabus for exactly how much each of these counts toward your grade.

MODULE 1 · Q1 · WEEKS 1-2

Introduction to Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
1	1.01 · The Question We Cannot Avoid *Primary source: Plato, Euthyphro*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Discussion: Your Own Euthyphro Moment · 100 pts
2	1.02 · The Universal Witness *Primary sources: Code of Hammurabi, Exodus 20, Analects of Confucius, Matthew 5–7*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Moral Convergence Across Traditions · 100 pts

MODULE 2 · Q1 · WEEKS 3-5

Obstacles to Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
3	1.03 · Is Morality Just Feeling? *Primary source: Ayer, Language, Truth and Logic*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: The Case Against Emotivism · 100 pts
4	1.04 · Is Morality Just Our Custom? *Primary source: Plato, Theaetetus (Protagoras section)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Evaluating Moral Relativism · 100 pts
5	1.05 · Is There a Fact About What Is Good? *Primary source: Nietzsche, Beyond Good and Evil (Preface, §1–6)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Can Morality Be Rationally Grounded? · 100 pts Module 2 Capstone: Do Any of the Obstacles Succeed? · 100 pts

MODULE 3 · Q1 · WEEKS 6-8

Science and Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
6	1.06 · Can Science Ground Ethics? *Primary source: Hume, Enquiry Concerning the Principles of Morals (Appendix I)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: What Does Moral Sentimentalism Explain? · 100 pts
7	1.07 · Does Evolution Explain Morality? *Primary source: Darwin, The Descent of Man (Ch. 4)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: What Evolution Can and Cannot Explain · 100 pts
8	1.08 · Psychology, Neuroscience, and Moral Judgment *Primary source: Haidt, "The Emotional Dog and Its Rational Tail" (2001)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: What the Scientific Approaches to Ethics Achieve · 100 pts Module 3 Capstone: What Can Science Tell Us About Morality? · 100 pts

MODULE 4 · Q1 · WEEK 9

How to Do Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
9	1.09 · How to Reason About Ethics	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Quarter 1 Reflection Essay (1.09A) · 100 pts Assignment: Moral Autobiography (1.09B) · 100 pts Module 4 Capstone: A Method for Doing Ethics · 100 pts *Quarter 1 ends this week.*

MODULE 1 · Q2 · WEEK 10

Moral Decisions

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
10	2.01 · A Decision That Divided the World *Primary source: Truman's announcement statement*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Consequentialism or Deontology at Hiroshima? · 20 pts Module 1 Capstone: Consequentialism and Deontology at Hiroshima · 100 pts

MODULE 2 · Q2 · WEEKS 11-13

Consequentialism

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
11	2.02 · Does the End Justify the Means? *Primary source: Mill, Utilitarianism (Ch. 1–2)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: The Logic of Consequentialism · 20 pts
12	2.03 · The Greatest Happiness Principle *Primary source: Bentham, Introduction to the Principles of Morals and Legislation (Ch. 1, 4)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Nozick's Experience Machine and Hedonism · 20 pts
13	2.04 · Applying and Testing Utilitarianism *Primary source: Mill, Utilitarianism (Ch. 3, 5)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: The Justice Objection to Utilitarianism · 100 pts Module 2 Capstone: Does Utilitarianism Survive Its Objections? · 100 pts

MODULE 3 · Q2 · WEEKS 14-15

Deontology

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
14	2.05 · The Good Will and the Categorical Imperative *Primary source: Kant, Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals (Sec. 1–2)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Applying the Categorical Imperative · 20 pts
15	2.06 · Human Dignity, Rights, and Objections to Kant *Primary sources: Kant, Groundwork (Sec. 3); Universal Declaration of Human Rights (Art. 1, 4, 5)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: The Case For or Against Kantian Deontology · 100 pts Module 3 Capstone: Does the Categorical Imperative Hold Up? · 100 pts

MODULE 4 · Q2 · WEEKS 16-18

Modern Moral Philosophy

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
16	2.07 · Ethics in Medicine, War, and Technology *Primary sources: The Belmont Report; Asilomar AI Principles*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Two Frameworks, One Dilemma · 20 pts
17	2.08 · Intuitionism, Social Contract, and Moral Particularism *Primary source: Rawls, A Theory of Justice (Sec. 1–4)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Which Alternative Fills the Gap? · 20 pts
18	2.09 · The Shared Assumption and the Turn to Virtue	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Consequentialism and Deontology, A Case Study Comparison · 100 pts Module 4 Capstone: Beyond Consequentialism and Deontology · 100 pts *Quarter 2 ends. Semester 1 ends this week.*

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